



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Colorado Classical School

School Website: <https://colorado-ccs.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: *STARTUP* SCL: *MEMBER*

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Colorado Classical School (Centennial, CO, 80122) (CCS) presents a robust CLASSICAL Christian profile across all six rubric categories. Public materials consistently tie education to a biblical worldview, explicitly referencing the fear of the Lord, theological grounding, and liturgical practices, while affirming classical aims through the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and Quadrivium, primary sources, and a commitment to memory work and contemplative pedagogy (scholé). The school describes its mission as nourishing minds, hearts, and bodies with what is true, good, and beautiful so that students glorify God and serve neighbors with joy and faithfulness, and it highlights virtuous faculty, parental partnership, and a structured, memory-based approach to learning. Evidence from CCS materials demonstrates strong alignment with the core elements of classical education, including a fixed liberal-arts curriculum, Socratic discussion in higher grades, and a living, mentored faculty culture, with active parent involvement. Accordingly, CCS receives a CLASSICAL rating across all six categories.

Key evidentiary anchors include: the explicit biblical grounding and Christian practices (prayer, Scripture, worship) and the central claim that all knowledge is rooted in God's truth, goodness, and beauty; the Trivium and Quadrivium framing with Socratic discussion and primary sources; a rest-filled, contemplative pedagogical ethos (scholé) alongside rigorous memory work; a mission that centers virtue, wisdom, and formation; a curriculum that foregrounds liberal arts and the Great Books/primary texts; a faculty described as virtuous and living curriculum; and a strong emphasis on parental partnership and public-facing openness to families and community. See CCS materials on religious foundations, mission, curriculum structure, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement for the supporting evidence.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The fear of the Lord is identified as the beginning of wisdom and knowledge, grounding all learning in biblical truth. - The school emphasizes Christian practices—prayer, singing, and Scripture reading—as regular, formative, communal activities. - Our Mission & Vision explicitly anchors education in a distinctly classical Christian framework so students may glorify God and serve neighbors with joy and faithfulness; the aims are explicitly theological. - Public materials continually reference a classical Christian worldview, integration of theology, and Christ-centered education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: fear of the Lord, biblical truth, Scripture, prayer, worship, theology, Christ-centered, imago Dei/theology-focused language, gospel, biblical worldview (multiple explicit instances). - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The materials consistently tie character formation and knowledge to transcendent, theologically grounded realities, with explicit liturgical and communal Christian practices. This aligns strongly with the category's Positive indicators and yields a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission states education is to nourish minds, hearts, and bodies with what is true, good, and beautiful so that students glorify God and serve their neighbor with joy and faithfulness. - The vision emphasizes formation, virtue, and wisdom rather than mere information or job preparation; it foregrounds human excellence and moral imagination within a liberal-arts frame. - The public narrative supports truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable, and a telos oriented toward virtue and wisdom.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, scholé, contemplation. - Negative keywords: references to workforce-preparation framing are minimal or absent; explicit negative signals are not present in CCS materials.

Why this rating - The explicit framing of education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a transcendent telos anchored in truth, goodness, and beauty, matches CLASSICAL expectations.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as the liberal arts tradition, emphasizing the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and Quadrivium (Arithmetic, Geometry, Music, Astronomy). - The school follows a Trivium-based approach with primary sources and Socratic discussion; Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric stages are referenced with developmentally appropriate pedagogy. - Emphasis on memorization, recitation, and the cultivation of wonder through classical texts and Great Books/primary sources (as reflected in public materials and comparisons with classical pedagogy).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; Trivium; Quadrivium; Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; primary sources; great books; history in a Western-civilization frame; memorization; recitation; wonder. - Negative keywords: signals such as “social studies replacing history” or over-emphasis on project-based learning are absent from CCS public materials; some negative indicators from the general Six Elements lexicon are not evidenced in CCS content.

Why this rating - CCS publicly commits to the core curriculum framework of liberal arts, Trivium/Quadrivium, primary sources, and memory-based pedagogy, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The pedagogy includes contemplative and restful elements (scholé) alongside rigorous learning; lower grades include singing/chanting to deepen memory and delight; upper grades feature Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training; students engage in structured memory work and public-speaking opportunities. - The school explicitly references Socratic discussion and primary sources as core modalities, with a rhythm of memory, recitation, and deliberative discourse integrated into high school seminars and rhetoric development. - There is clear emphasis on contemplative, restful learning at times, with structured difficulty, and a rhythm of memory work (chanting, recitation, etc.).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé, contemplation, restfulness, memory work, recitation, chanting, singing, memory-based learning, Socratic discussion, seminars, rhetoric, debate, oratory, public speaking, masterful texts. - Negative keywords: there is no clear signaling of heavy experiential-only or constructivist approaches in CCS materials; the negative signals from the Six Elements lexicon do not appear in CCS public content.

Why this rating - CCS pedagogy integrates contemplative/restful learning with intellectual rigor through Socratic discourse and rhetorical training, matching the classical pedagogy as described in the Six Elements lexicon.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty is described as high-character, subject-matter experts who model virtue; they are the living curriculum and central to the school's culture; there is emphasis on a collegial, mentor-like framework and formation of teachers through classical pedagogy. - Vision for Our Faculty calls for teachers who joyfully love God, model virtue and wisdom, and inspire wonder; teachers are described as "gifted in teaching and abounding in love for their students." - The public materials present teachers and staff as central to partnership with parents and to the fidelity of classical education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: virtuous teachers; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; excellence; mastery; mentorship; virtue formation; wisdom; character formation. - Negative keywords: standard certification-only approach without classical context is not evident in CCS content.

Why this rating - CCS positions faculty as the core of the school's classical mission and living curriculum, consistent with classical benchmarks.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - CCS emphasizes partnership with parents as co-teachers and primary stewards of classical formation; it explicitly invites parental engagement, informs families about methods and goals, and invites visits and involvement. - Vision for Our Parents includes expectations for parental responsibility, informed participation, engagement with classical literature and culture, and support for school staff. - Materials describe a transparent relationship with families, open invitations for visits, and communal events that align with liturgical and cultural rhythm.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental formation; book studies; seminars; classical book clubs; open campus; hospitality; parent covenant; family liturgy; liturgical year events; feasts and festivals; home catechesis; involvement and visitation. - Negative keywords: consumerist language or passive parent roles are not evident; content emphasizes active parental engagement (positive in this framework).

Why this rating - The public materials present a robust model of parent involvement and community partnership, consistent with classical education norms.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required. CCS already presents a cohesive CLASSICAL profile across all six categories, with explicit biblical grounding, Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum, contemplative pedagogy, living faculty, and active parental partnership. If a school wanted to push further toward a formalized "Great Books" emphasis or to broaden explicit historical/Western-civilizational transmission, it could strengthen explicit references to Great Books in curricula and outcomes; however, current evidence already aligns strongly with classical education norms.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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